



ADANI FOUNDATION'S PROJECT UTTHAN TRANSFORMING EDUCATION IN GOVERNMENT SCHOOLS

Improving students' basic skills is important for better results in board exams, especially in government high schools. Adani Foundation, the corporate social responsibility (CSR) arm of the Adani Group, recognised the need to boost reading and math skills at the primary level and stepped in to provide a focused solution. With a lot of experience running schools in rural areas, the Adani Foundation understands the challenges that government schools face. These include a high student-teacher ratio, unmotivated teachers, lack of basic facilities and resources, limited capacity-building opportunities for teachers, a lack of accountability among stakeholders, and high student dropout rates.

After a comprehensive needs assessment, the Foundation launched Project Uthtan in the academic year 2018-19 with 17 government primary schools in Mundra as a pilot. The project's goal was to adopt these schools and, within three years, transform them into model schools. The programme aims to bridge the above-mentioned gaps by focusing on improving the quality of education, mainstreaming progressive learners, and creating an enabling learning environment.

To achieve these objectives, the programme has introduced Uthtan Sahayaks, a cadre of empowered educators selected from within

the community. The Sahayaks are dedicated to strengthening basic literacy and numeracy, focusing particularly on 'priya' students – the progressive learners. They act as catalysts and key influencers for the project.

After identifying progressive learners, a customised curriculum is implemented through special classes during school hours. As a result, every year, 60% of these identified learners from Classes 3-6 become proficient in reading, writing, and basic arithmetic. During intervention by the Foundation, it was found that none of the government schools had active libraries. Although funds and

